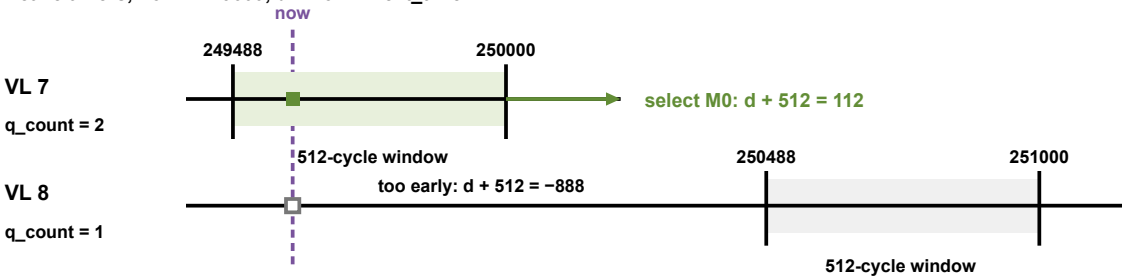
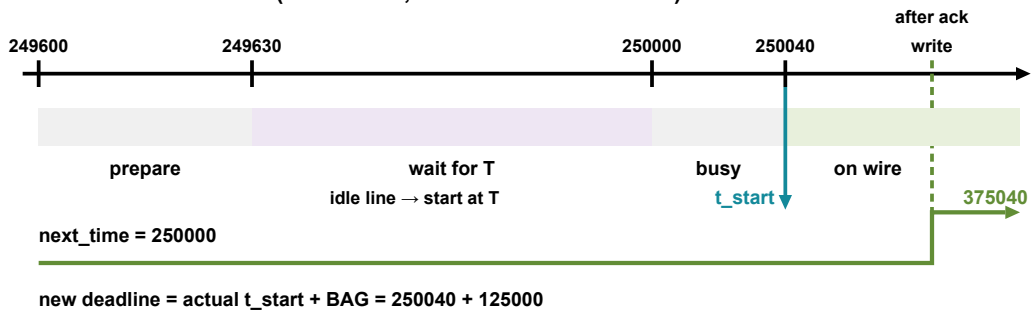
Eligibility is a time window; pending temporarily excludes the selected VL

Active timers; now = 249600; d = now − next_time



Grant M0: q_count 2 → 1; pend_vl = 7 blocks M1 until START clears pending.

M0 timeline and the stored deadline (illustrative; lower axis not to scale)



Prepared before T + idle line → start at T. timer_active = 0 → skip the T check.